



Figure 1: GNOME 3 desktop after system startup



Figure 2: The Windows tab at work, displaying all the open windows

displays all the apps, but the category list is located on the right. There is a search bar included above the category list, where you can type the name of the app or file that you are looking for. However, the search bar failed to work in the GNOME 3 preview. The shell displays error messages and status messages in a pop-up screen, which does not interfere with the application that you are currently using. In the bottom right corner, you will get a *gnome-settings-daemon* icon that is used to change the screen resolution, which I believe is a feature of OpenSUSE. The app that is currently active has its icon placed adjacent to the Activities button.

Hardware integration

Deeper integration with the hardware is a key feature of GNOME 3, as mentioned by its developers. When tested on my laptop, it automatically added the *Suspend* option, but failed

to start the battery indicator applet. It even started Compiz on detecting the graphics card. When a device is plugged in, GNOME 3 immediately detects it and displays a status message at the bottom. The system settings option in the menu can be used to configure the devices. GNOME 3 displays the configuration icon for devices in the system settings only for devices that are detected. It does make full use of the hardware, but there is always room for improvement.

Social networking from the desktop

Social networking is built on Empathy, which uses the Telepathy framework. You can add your Google, Facebook and other chat accounts by entering the details in Empathy. The *My Account* option on the top right corner menu is only to add user details, and not chat accounts. In case you are using some other application and your friend types a chat message, Empathy

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